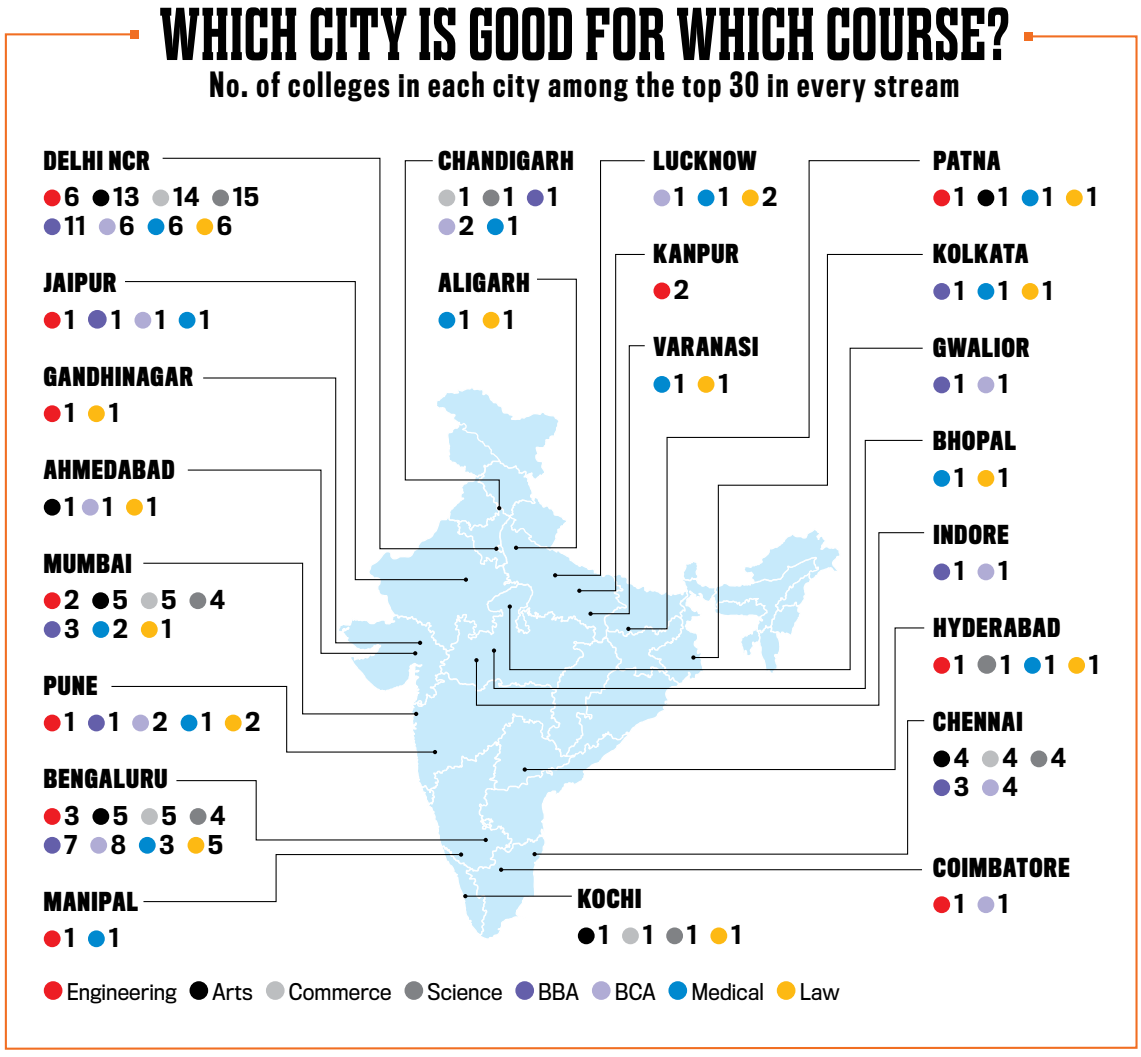


will no longer be held hostage to their performance in the Class 12 board examinations. CUET provides them a level-playing field, so that students from boards that have a more lenient system of marking do not score an advantage over others. Instead, everyone takes a uniform examination and gets an equal shot at choosing the college and course of their choice. Nor do students and their parents have to camp in big cities for the summer, when college admissions take place, uncertain of whether they will get admission in the course and college they have applied for. Students can appear for the entrance test from their home town and travel only when admission in a particular college is confirmed.

CUET is also liberating for students as it allows them to choose the subjects they wish to be evaluated in. They can appear for the exam in six different subjects from a list of subjects they studied in 10+2. This means they can take the test in subjects they think they are comfortable in or wish to pursue a career in. What this also means is that students need to be aware of not just the overall reputation of a college but also the strength of its respective departments. A college could well be the best in a particular stream but not necessarily have the best department for a specific subject.

In its 27th edition, therefore, the India Today Best Colleges survey has introduced a new category—best colleges in individual subjects. In the first year of this exercise, 12 subjects under two streams—arts and science—have been identified. These are English, Hindi, Sanskrit, History, Political Science, Sociology, Psychology, Economics, Physics, Chemistry, Botany and Zoology, Hindi and Sanskrit. The evaluation is based on the objective data submitted by the colleges.

This year, we have also launched

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